



ULAB

UNIVERSITY OF LIBERAL ARTS
BANGLADESH

Topic: Propaganda Speech

Submitted By

Name: Al Eakram Mahmud Shoumik

ID: 223012003

Course Code: MSJ 3243

Course Title: Speech Writing and Public Speaking

Section: 01

Submitted To

Syeda Sadia Mehjabin

Senior Lecturer

Bachelor of Social Science, Media Studies and Journalism (MSJ)

University of Liberal Arts Bangladesh (Ulab)

Summary and Background of the CI's Chosen Theory: Network Propaganda

The Network Propaganda theory, outlined by Yochai Benkler, Robert Faris, and Hal Roberts, gives the explanation of how digital media ecosystems, especially social media, have transformed the way propaganda spreads in society. Rather than classic top-down broadcast, disinformation now spreads horizontally across networks of akin communities and media channels. In this case, propaganda isn't state-fabricated falsehood anymore—It's a structural occurrence fueled by attention economies, algorithmic amplification, and ideological echo chambers. This theory illustrates how people are manipulated not just by deception, but by selective presentation, repetition, and emotional cues that play on public opinion.

In the July Movement case, this theory describes the manner by which the disinformation spread through social media created urgency and outrage among youth. It was a typical example of how a networked disinformation campaign can mobilize passion, manipulate identity, and undermine democratic institutions without appearing to be artificial or organized.

Audience Analysis Report

Speaker: Al Eakram Mahmud Shoumik

Topic: Unmasking the Truth Behind the July Movement: A Lesson on Network Propaganda

Audience for this speech: General public of Bangladesh, especially the youth and political activists in universities, and community leaders and media practitioners.

Specific purpose of my speech: To enlighten the public on how disinformation and misinformation are spread throughout the July Movement and how Network Propaganda was utilized to affect the youth.

How I will narrow down the topic so it will be applicable to this audience: I will focus on how misinformation, specifically via social media, influenced young people during the July Movement. I'll avoid academic jargon and instead use real-life events, simple analogies, and emotional appeal to make the content accessible.

Demographic Audience Analysis

- Age:** Primarily 18–35 (university students and young professionals)
- Sex:** Mixed gender audience (Male and Female Both)
- Religion:** Muslim, Hindu, Buddhist, Christian and others
- Racial/Ethnic background:** Bengali majority with minority groups
- Group membership:** Political student groups
- Other:** Technologically savvy, socially engaged, politically curious

Situational Audience Analysis

- **Size:** Huge national or television audience—thousands are possible
- **Response to physical setting:** Formal and attentive; possibly in a national television broadcast or press conference
- **Knowledge about the topic:** Moderate; everyone has heard of the July Movement but does not know the background or clandestine manipulations
- **Interest level:** High; current events have affected their lives and their opinions
- **Attitude toward the topic:** Polarized; some support the movement; others view it as destructive
- **Disposition towards the speaker:** Mixed; as BCL president, some will be wary
- **Disposition towards the occasion:** Guarded and inquiring

Audience Adaptation Worksheet

What device(s) I will use in the introduction to gain attention:

1. Emotional storytelling about students misled by online propaganda
2. Employing rhetorical inquiries: “What happens if a deception shapes your convictions?”
3. A compelling statement: “Untruths soar, while reality trails behind in a struggle.”

What steps I will take to relate the topic directly to my audience:

1. Reference real-life university incidents from the July Movement
2. Speak in first-person, positioning myself as someone who also values student voices
3. Emphasize shared values: peace, progress, and patriotism

Main Points of the Speech:

1. **Unmasking the Origins of the July Movement:** To show it was not an organic protest but ideologically driven by misinformation.
2. **How Network Propaganda Fueled the Movement:** To demonstrate how social media and false narratives targeted youth emotions.
3. **The Real Impact: Chaos Over Cause:** To highlight how ordinary people, not politicians, suffered the most.
4. **The Path Forward: Conscious Citizenship:** To call for digital literacy, critical thinking, and unity.

Why These Points: They progress logically from awareness to action. They also align with the cognitive (understand the truth), affective (feel betrayed by lies), and behavioral (become more critical) goals of the speech.

Why I have Selected These Supporting Materials:

1. Real-life incidents and media headlines to build credibility
2. Statistics on misinformation to ground emotional appeals
3. Quotes from student leaders to show balance
4. Network Propaganda theory simplified to provide a theoretical lens

What steps I Have taken to make my language clear and appropriate:

1. Use of simple Bangla and English words
2. Avoid jargon; instead, use metaphors like “digital poison” and “idea virus”
3. Empathetic tone to reduce defensiveness

What adjustments I will make in delivery:

1. **Rate of speech:** Moderate and clear, slowing down during emotional parts
2. **Volume:** Steady with occasional emphasis
3. **Tone:** Calm but firm
4. **Gestures:** Open hand gestures to show transparency
5. **Eye contact:** Maintain with the audience and camera
6. **Facial expressions:** Reflect empathy, disappointment, and hope

I am Al Eakram Mahmud Shoumik. Suppose I am the president of Bangladesh Chhatra League. The following speech was given to the nation after the July Movement:

Dear countrymen,

Today I have come before you to expose a movement that wanted to plunge our beloved peaceful country into the quicksand of a deep conspiracy. Yes, I am talking about the July Movement. This movement was not actually for any legitimate demand but rather a well-planned political conspiracy.

This movement started by leading some misguided youth astray. They were given weapons of lies and hatred. They raised slogans, “We want our rights.” But their real intention was to destabilise the country, to overthrow an elected government.

One after another, false rumours were spread around this movement. The youth were agitated by spreading misleading information using social media. Their minds were poisoned against the government. They were taught that the government was their enemy.

Behind this movement were some self-interested political parties and foreign powers. They wanted to weaken our country to achieve their own interests. They knew that it is easy to create chaos in a country by using the emotions of the youth.

During the July Movement, we saw how violence and vandalism were carried out. Government property was destroyed, and the lives of ordinary people were endangered. This movement proved how some people do not hesitate to harm the country for their own interests.

Another big lie of this movement was that they were fighting for the common people. But in reality, they made the lives of ordinary people miserable. Innocent people who were innocent were affected by their violence.

Dear countrymen, we must remember that lies and conspiracies can never survive in the face of truth. The July Movement could not either. The conscious citizens of the country have unmasked their lies and conspiracies.

Today, when we look at the July Movement, the question arises in our minds: why did some young people take such a wrong path? Why did they indulge in the game of destroying their own country? The answer lies in our education system, in our social values.

We need to teach our youth how to recognise the truth and how to resist lies. We need to install patriotism and a sense of responsibility in them. We need to make them understand that violence can never be the solution to any problem.

The July Movement has shown us how lies and conspiracies can endanger our country. Thus, we must be more observant and more aware.

We must work together and stay united so no evil power can divide our nation. Our youth must be led in the correct direction to contribute to the country’s progress.

Together, let us all create a stunning, wealthy Bangladesh where deceit and conspiracy will find no space.

Thank you all. Joy Bangla! Joy Bongobondhu!